[INCH-POUND]
NN-H-106D
January 29, 1996
SUPERSEDING
NN-H-00106C
November 1, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HANDLES; WOOD, MISCELLANEOUS (FOR) TOOLS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Federal Specification by all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers handles for use on chisels, files, saws, and nonelectric soldering irons (copper).

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not cover all varieties of the commodity indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types, classes, and styles. Handles shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Chisel handles, socket firmer

Size 1 (small)
Size 2 (medium)
Size 3 (large)

Type II - Files handles

Size 1 (small)
Size 2 (medium)
Size 3 (large)

Type III - Saw handles

Type IV - Soldering iron handles

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any other data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Tools and Appliances Commodity Center (6FETE-CO), Washington, DC 20406.

FSC 5110

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Federal Specification:

PPP-P-40 - Preservation and Packing of Hand Tools and Tool Accessories for Power Driven, Metal and Woodworking Machinery

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and Commercial Item Descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

(Single copies of this specification, and other Federal specifications and Commercial Item Descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.)

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American National Standards Institute (ANSI)/American Society of Quality Control (ASQC):

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Quality Control, P.O. Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Illustrations. Illustrations herein are descriptive and not restrictive and are not intended to preclude the purchase of handles otherwise conforming to this specification.

3.2 Material. Chisel handles shall be hickory or hard maple. Saw handles shall be of applewood, beech, or laminated wood as specified in the procurement document. File handles and soldering iron handles shall be of any species of wood used commercially for the purpose.

3.3. Quality. Handles shall be sound and free of defects. The ferrules shall be free of burrs and rust which may affect the appearance or serviceability of the handle.

3.4 Moisture content. The moisture content of handles shall not exceed 15 percent.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5 Dimensions. Chisel, file, and soldering iron handles shall conform to the dimensions of the respective figures and tables incorporated herein with tolerances of ± 1/8 inch in transverse dimensions and ± 1/16 inch in overall dimensions. Saw handles shall conform to the details specified in the procurement document.

3.6 Type I, chisel handles. Type I handles shall be similar to Figure 1 and shall conform to Table I for the size specified (see 6.2). Each handle shall be capped or tipped with layers of leather, totaling a minimum of 3/8 inch in thickness. The leather shall be secured to the handle and shaped so as to withstand the blows of mallets or hammers.

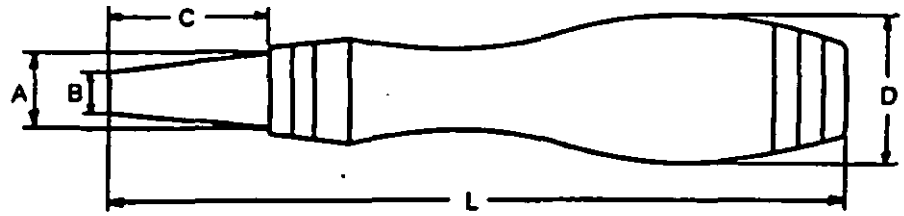


Figure 1. Type I, chisel handles.

TABLE I. Type I, chisel handles

Size	Largest diameter D (Inches)	Overall length L (Inches)	Tapered portion		
			Largest A (Inch)	Smallest B (Inch)	Length ± 1/8 inch C (Inches)
1 (Small)	1	5-1/4	11/16	1/2	1-1/16
2 (Medium)	1-1/16	5-3/8	3/4	9/16	1-1/4
3 (Large)	1-3/16	5-1/2	7/8	5/8	1-1/4

3.7 Type II, file handles. Type II handles shall be similar to Figure 2 and shall conform to Table II for the size specified (see 6.2). The front or small end of the file handles shall be equipped with a substantial metal ferrule, at least 1/4 the length of the handle, or a substantial wire wound cap at least 1/4 the length of the handle designed to prevent the handle from splitting when the tang end of the file is inserted (forced) into the handle under service conditions. If equipped with a metal ferrule, the ferrule shall be seamless and fabricated of not less than 22 gauge (1/32 inch) material. Each metal ferrule shall be impressed around its full diameter in a manner to prevent separation of the ferrule from the handle. Each handle shall be drilled axially to half its length with a tolerance of ± 3/8 inch. The diameter of the drilled hole for the tang end shall be as specified in Table II. The bore shall be clear and unobstructed its entire length.

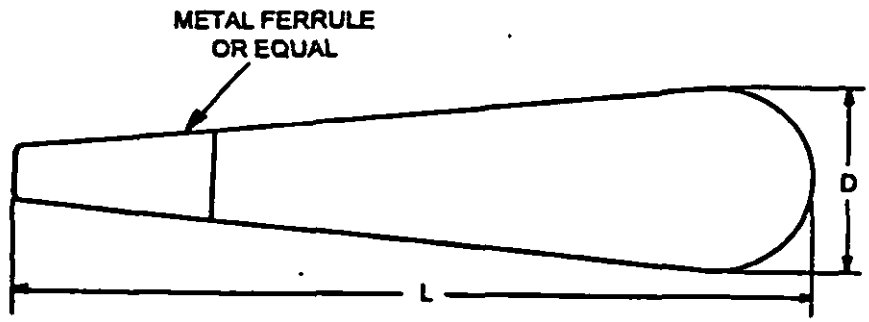


Figure 2. Type II, file handles.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Type II, file handles

Size	Diameter of handle D ± 1/16 (Inches)	Overall length L ± 1/8 (Inches)	Suitable for files of the following lengths (Inches)	Diameter of drilled hole for tang end (Inch)
1 (Small)	1	4	3 - 6	1/8
2 (Medium)	1-1/4	4-1/2	6 - 10	11/64
3 (Large)	1-1/2	5-1/2	10 - 14	5/16 (± 1/64)

3.8 Type III, saw handles. Type III handles shall be in accordance with the requirements of the procurement document.

3.9 Type IV, soldering iron handles. Type IV handles shall conform to the dimensions of and be similar to Figure 3. Each handle shall be equipped with a suitable metal ferrule secured to the handle. Each handle shall be drilled axially to half it length with a hole of suitable diameter to accept the tang end of a soldering iron.

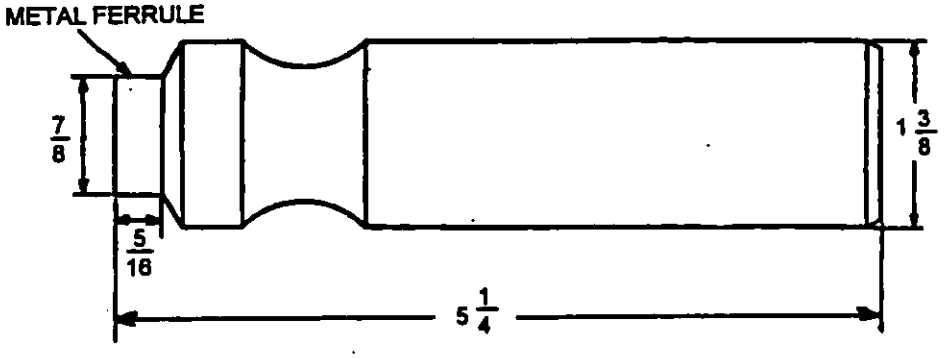


Figure 3. Type IV, soldering iron handle.

3.10 Finish. All handles shall be smoothly finished.

3.11 Marking. Each item shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or identifying symbol and the state or country of manufacture. The marking shall be engraved, etched, or stamped in such a manner that it will be permanent to the extent that it will remain clear and legible throughout the life of the item.

3.12 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, provided they fall within the tolerances specified and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the specification preparing activity for change to this document.

3.13 Workmanship: Details of workmanship shall be in accordance with the best commercial standards and practices. Paints, coatings, platings, and finishes shall be smooth, dry, adherent, continuous, and not stained or discolored. Fasteners shall be firmly secured and show no evidence of deformation, cross threading, or hazardous burrs. Adhesives and lubricants adequate for their intended purpose shall be properly and neatly applied. Adhesives shall be adequately cured. Wires and cables shall be neatly dressed and shall not be frayed or in contact with sharp edges. Wire and cable insulation shall show no evidence of burns, abrading, or pinch marks. There shall be no interference, binding, or galling of parts. External and bearing surfaces shall be free of tool and gouge marks,

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

nicks, or other surface imperfections. The item shall be clean and free of corrosion and debris (e.g., chips, shavings, slivers) or other foreign material. The item shall be free from manufacturing workmanship defects (e.g., loose, missing, binding or misaligned parts, sharp or rough external edges, corners, or surfaces) and material workmanship defects (e.g., pits, rips, fins, burrs, tears, nodules, cracks, blisters) which may adversely impact the item's serviceability, durability, safety, or appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specification and standards to the extent specified, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Inspection lot. All handles of the same type and size offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of inspection.

4.2.2 Sampling for inspection. A random sample of handles shall be selected from each lot for inspection. The size of the sample and the acceptance and rejection numbers shall be as indicated in Table III.

TABLE III. Sampling for inspection

Lot size	Sample size	Acceptance number	Rejection number
2 to 15	lot size	0	1
16 to 110	15	0	1
111 to 800	35	1	2
801 to 1300	50	2	3
1301 to 3200	75	3	4
3201 and over	150	5	6

4.3 Inspection.

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional inspection. Each of the sample handles selected in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be inspected to verify compliance with this specification. Any handle in the sample containing on one more visual or dimensional defects, or which has been rejected for moisture content as specified in 4.4.1, shall be rejected, and if the number of rejected handles in any sample exceeds the acceptance number of that sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

4.4 Test procedures.

4.4.1 Moisture content. A random sample of handles shall be selected from each lot to verify compliance with the moisture content requirement of 3.4. Sample size and the acceptance and rejection number shall be in accordance with ANSI/ASQC Z 1.4, inspection level S-3, and with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 6.5.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

An electrical moisture meter or other equally suitable method shall be used to determine moisture content. Any handle in the sample having a moisture content in excess of 15 percent shall be rejected.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking shall be in accordance with PPP-P-40. The level of preservation, packaging, and packing shall be A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The handles covered by this specification shall be used for chisels, files, handsaws (replacement only), and soldering irons.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type and size of item required (see 1.2).
c. Level of preservation, packaging, and packing required (see 5.1).
d. Marking, if other than specified.

6.3 Treatment. Rough bolts as well as unfinished squares and stored handles may sometimes be severely damaged by infestations of insects, generally Lyctus powder-post beetles. Bolts out during the season when insects are active are subject to attack by Lyctus beetles as soon as the moisture content is below 20 percent. This is also true of unfinished squares of manufactured but unfinished handle stock and similar items. Fortunately Lyctus attack can be prevented by dipping the wood items in an insecticide. To be effective, the insecticide must be applied to raw wood since it will not penetrate paints, varnishes, lacquers, waxes or other finishing materials. Lyctus infestations can be very costly. Adequate treatments are relatively inexpensive and should be included as part of the manufacturing process.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.